

Explicit And Implicit Information (Inference)

A. Understanding Explicit vs. Implicit Questions

To tackle these questions efficiently, you must first identify what the question is asking for:

1. Explicit Information Questions

- What it is: The answer is stated directly in the text. The author uses exact words or close synonyms.
- Common Question Stems:
 - *According to the passage, ...*
 - *Which of the following is TRUE about X?*
 - *The author states that...*
- Strategy: Use keyword *scanning*. Find the specific term in the text and match it with the correct option.

2. Implicit Information (Inference) Questions

- What it is: The answer is NOT written in the text. You must act like a detective, using the given clues to draw a 100% logical conclusion.
- Common Question Stems:
 - *It can be inferred from the passage that...*
 - *The passage implies that...*
 - *Which of the following would the author most likely agree with?*
- Strategy: Read the clues carefully. The correct inference must have a strong "evidential anchor" in the text. If an option requires you to make a wild guess or jump to wild assumptions, it is wrong.

B. Worked-Out Example & Detailed Review

Read the following passage carefully:

The fast fashion industry relies heavily on synthetic fibers like polyester, a plastic derived from crude oil. Polyester is favored by manufacturers because it is incredibly cheap to produce, highly durable, and allows for rapid mass production of cheap clothing. However, washing these garments releases millions of microplastics into the wastewater, which public filtration systems fail to capture.

Consequently, these microscopic plastic particles end up in the marine ecosystem. Marine organisms, from tiny zooplankton to commercial fish species, mistake these particles for food. Since microplastics cannot be digested, they accumulate in the tissues of these marine animals, gradually moving up the food chain and eventually landing on human dinner plates.

Question 1 (Explicit):

According to the passage, why do clothing manufacturers prefer using polyester over other materials?

- A. It is the only material that public filtration systems can easily capture.
- B. It is a natural fiber that enhances the lifespan of everyday garments.
- C. It is cost-effective, durable, and enables fast-paced mass production.
- D. It prevents marine organisms from ingesting toxic plastic particles.
- E. It is derived from organic compounds that naturally decompose.

- Answer Explanation:

This is an explicit question. Let's scan the text for "manufacturers prefer/favor". Paragraph 1 states: *"Polyester is favored by manufacturers because it is incredibly cheap to produce (cost-effective), highly durable, and allows for rapid mass production"*. Option C matches this factual statement perfectly.

Correct Answer: C

Question 2 (Implicit/Inference):

It can be inferred from the passage that the consumption of fast fashion products...

- A. Will completely eliminate the need for public wastewater filtration systems.
- B. Indirectly contributes to the potential ingestion of microplastics by humans.
- C. Is safe for the environment as long as the clothes are washed frequently.
- D. Forces marine organisms to adapt and find alternative natural food sources.
- E. Only damages the health of commercial fish species but spares humans.

- Answer Explanation:

This is an implicit question. Let's look at the logical chain of clues given in the text:

- Washing fast fashion clothes releases microplastics → Filtration systems fail to catch them → Fish eat them → Microplastics move up the food chain → Fish end up on human dinner plates.

From this chain, we can logically infer that humans buying and washing fast fashion products will *indirectly* end up eating those microplastics through the food chain. Option B is the only logically sound inference.

Correct Answer: B

C. Independent Practice Task

Passage for Practice:

The introduction of the Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol (DHCP) revolutionized network administration by automating the assignment of IP addresses to devices on a network. Before DHCP, network administrators had to manually configure every single computer, a tedious process highly prone to human error and IP conflicts. While DHCP drastically reduces the administrative workload, it leaves networks vulnerable to a cyber threat known as *DHCP Spoofing*, where a rogue server injects false configuration settings into client devices.

Question:

What can be inferred about computer networks prior to the invention of DHCP?

- A. They were completely immune to any form of cyber threats and hacking.
- B. They required heavy manual configuration and were susceptible to configuration mistakes.
- C. They operated much faster because IP addresses were assigned permanently.
- D. They did not require network administrators to manage their infrastructure.
- E. They were primarily vulnerable to DHCP Spoofing attacks.